QRcode tool

User Manual

Scan QR codes on your computer as easily as on your phone.



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For Windows 10 (21H2 or later) / Windows 11, macOS 13 or later and Linux

Contents

1 Introducing QRcode tool 1
1.1 Main features 1
1.2 System requirements 2
1.3 Privacy and safety principles 2
1.4 Conventions used in this manual 2

2 Installation and first start 3
2.1 Download and install (Windows) 3
2.2 If Windows shows “Windows protected your PC” 3
2.3 macOS and Linux 3
2.4 The welcome screen 4
2.5 The tray icon 4

3 Scanning the screen 6
3.1 Scan the whole screen 6
3.2 Select an area 7
3.3 The toolbar on the scan screen 8
3.4 Keyboard 8
3.5 When no code is found 8

4 Other ways to scan 9
4.1 Webcam 9
4.2 Image on the clipboard 10
4.3 Image files 10
4.4 Windows right-click menu 11
4.5 Command line 13

5 Results and details 14
5.1 Result labels 14
5.2 What Enter or a click does 14
5.3 The detail card 14
5.4 Buttons for each kind of content 15
5.5 Taiwan e-invoices 16
5.6 Sensitive data 16

6 Link safety 17
6.1 Check the site name before opening 17
6.2 Warning levels 17
6.3 What is checked 18
6.4 Deceptive links 18
6.5 Trusted sites and automatic opening 19

7 Floating toolbar and bubble 21
7.1 Toolbar buttons 21
7.2 Vertical toolbar (right or left) 22

7.3 Moving the toolbar 23
7.4 The floating bubble 23
7.5 Hiding during full-screen apps 23

8 Creating QR codes 25
8.1 Error correction 25

9 Settings 27
9.1 General 27
9.2 Scanning 28
9.3 Camera 29
9.4 Shortcuts 30
9.5 Privacy & history 31
9.6 About 32

10 Updating and uninstalling 33
10.1 Checking for and installing updates 33
10.2 Portable version 33
10.3 Uninstalling 33
10.4 Where settings and logs are stored 34

11 Troubleshooting 35

A Shortcuts and keys at a glance 37

B Supported codes 38

CHAPTER 1

1 Introducing QRcode tool

QRcode tool is a small desktop program that waits in the system tray and reads QR codes and barcodes from your screen. When you press its shortcut, the screen is frozen for a moment and every code on it gets a result label that shows what kind of content it holds and, for links, the real site name. Press **Enter** or click the label to open the link, join the Wi-Fi network or save the contact.

It can also read codes held up to your webcam, pictures on the clipboard and image files, and it includes a simple QR code generator.

1.1 Main features

Feature	Description
Scan whole screen	Freezes all monitors, finds every code automatically and labels it. Works with videos and games too.
Select area	Drag a box around a single code. Use it for codes that are too small, blurry or tilted to be found automatically.
Webcam	Hold a printed code or a phone screen up to the camera; results appear as soon as the code is recognised.
Clipboard and image files	Reads a screenshot you just copied, or PNG, JPEG, BMP, GIF and WebP files.
Understands the content	Recognises web links, Wi-Fi, contacts, email, phone numbers, text messages, map locations, 2-step verification keys, payment addresses and Taiwan e-invoices, and offers matching buttons.
Link safety checks	Before a link is opened it is checked for unencrypted connections, disguised addresses, look-alike letters, IP addresses, short links and other common tricks. All checks run offline.
Create QR codes	Turns text or a link into a QR code that you can copy or save as PNG or SVG.
Floating toolbar and bubble	A toolbar that sits at the top of the screen (horizontal) or at the right or left edge (vertical), and that collapses into a small round bubble.
Languages	English, Traditional Chinese, Simplified Chinese, Japanese, Korean, Spanish, Portuguese (Brazil), French, German and Russian.

1.2 System requirements

Operating system	Requirements and notes
Windows	Windows 10 21H2 or later, Windows 11. x64 and ARM64. No administrator rights are needed to install.
macOS	macOS 13 or later (Apple silicon and Intel). Screen Recording permission is required for the first scan, Camera permission for webcam scanning.
Linux	All features on X11. On Wayland, scanning is started through a keyboard shortcut you set up in your desktop settings (see Chapter 4).
Hardware	Any ordinary office computer. A webcam is optional. The program uses less than about 30 MB of memory while idle.

1.3 Privacy and safety principles

- Decoding and link checks run on your computer. Scanned content is never uploaded, and no web service is asked about the reputation of an address.
- The only network connection is the optional automatic update check, which asks GitHub whether a newer version exists.
- The scan history is off by default. Even when it is on, Wi-Fi passwords and 2-step verification keys are never stored.
- Only `http` and `https` addresses can be opened. Other kinds of links can only be copied; they are never handed to the system.
- A link with a warning always shows its details first and waits for you.

1.4 Conventions used in this manual

- Buttons, options and window names are shown in **bold**, for example **Settings** or **Scan whole screen**.
- Keys are shown as key caps, for example **Enter** or **Ctrl+Alt+Q**.
- **Settings › General** means: open the **Settings** window and choose the **General** page on the left.
- The pictures show Windows 11. macOS and Linux work the same way; only the window frames and system menus look different.

CHAPTER 2

2 Installation and first start

2.1 Download and install (Windows)

1. Open the release page on GitHub (https://github.com/Lrniey666/qrcode-tool/releases/latest).
2. Download `QRcodeTool-win-x64-Setup.exe` for most computers, or `QRcodeTool-win-arm64-Setup.exe` for computers with an ARM processor.
3. Run the downloaded file. QRcode tool is installed for your user account only and does not need administrator rights.
4. When setup finishes, QRcode tool starts and shows the welcome screen.

> **Tip** If you prefer not to install anything, download the `Portable.zip` file, unpack it and run the program directly. The portable version cannot update itself.

2.2 If Windows shows “Windows protected your PC”

Current releases are not code-signed yet, so Windows SmartScreen may warn about an unknown publisher. This is common for new, unsigned programs.

1. In the warning, click **More info**.
2. Check that the app name is QRcode tool, then click **Run anyway**.

To make sure the download has not been altered, run the following command in PowerShell and compare the result with the `SHA256SUMS` file on the release page:

```
Get-FileHash .\QRcodeTool-win-x64-Setup.exe -Algorithm SHA256
```

2.3 macOS and Linux

macOS: download and install the `.pkg` file. Releases are not notarized by Apple yet, so the first time, right-click the app and choose **Open**. On the first scan, allow QRcode tool under **System Settings › Privacy & Security › Screen Recording**, and under **Camera** if you want to use the webcam.

Linux: download the `.AppImage` file, make it executable and run it. GNOME needs the “AppIndicator

and KStatusNotifierItem Support" extension to show tray icons.

2.4 The welcome screen

The welcome screen appears on the first start. It shows the three most common ways to scan, with their shortcuts, and explains that links never open by surprise.

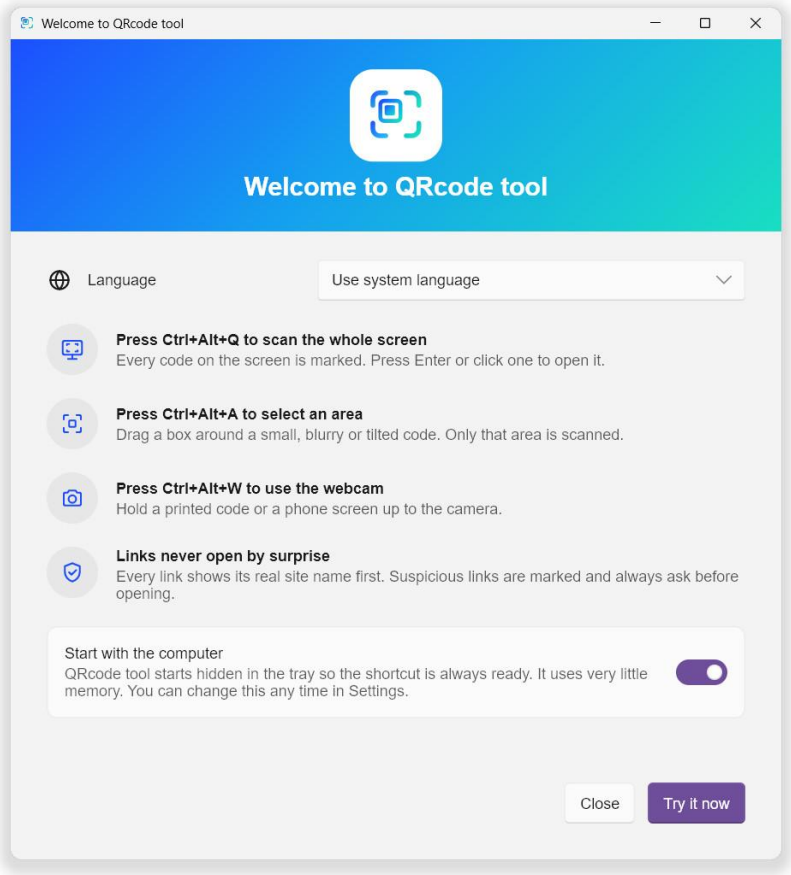


Figure 2-1 The welcome screen on the first start

- **Language:** follows your operating system by default. A change here takes effect immediately.
- **Start with the computer:** on by default so the shortcut is always ready. You can turn it off here or later in **Settings › General**.
- **Try it now:** closes the welcome screen and scans the whole screen once.
- **Close:** closes the welcome screen and shows the floating toolbar.

To see the welcome screen again, open **Settings › General** and click **Show the welcome screen again**.

2.5 The tray icon

QRcode tool has no traditional main window. After it starts, its icon appears in the system tray at the

right end of the taskbar, and every feature can be reached from there.

- **Click the icon:** scans the whole screen right away.
- **Right-click:** opens the menu (Figure 2-2).
- **Hover over the icon:** shows the current scan shortcut.

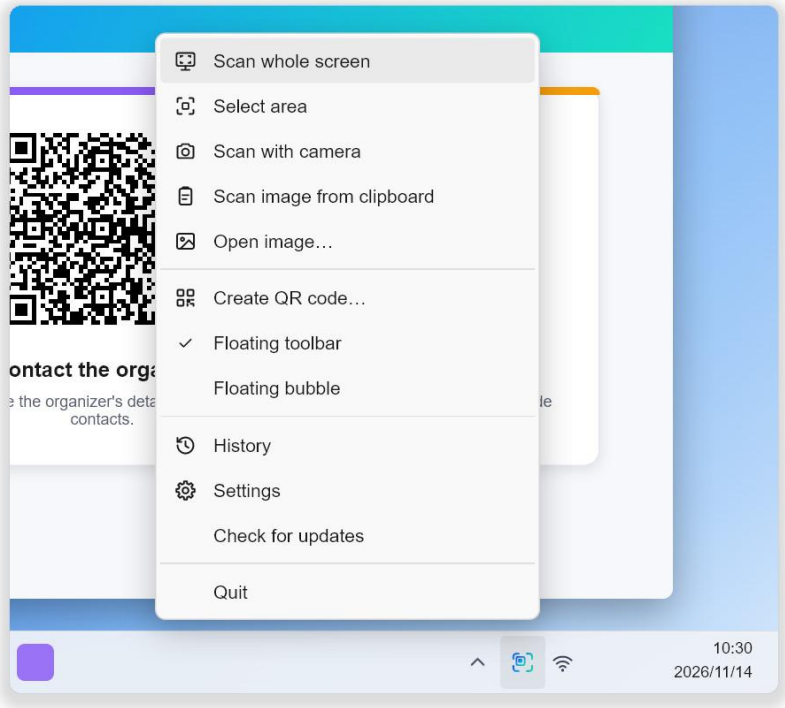


Figure 2-2 The tray icon menu

> **Tip** Windows may hide new tray icons behind the "^" arrow. Drag the icon onto the taskbar to keep it visible.

CHAPTER 3

3 Scanning the screen

3.1 Scan the whole screen

1. Make sure the web page, document, video or picture with the QR code is visible.
2. Press **Ctrl+Alt+Q**, click the tray icon, or click **Scan whole screen** on the floating toolbar.
3. The screen freezes and darkens. After a short scan sweep, every code found gets a result label.
4. Press **Enter** to open the selected code, or click the label you want.
5. Press **Esc** or right-click to leave the scan screen.

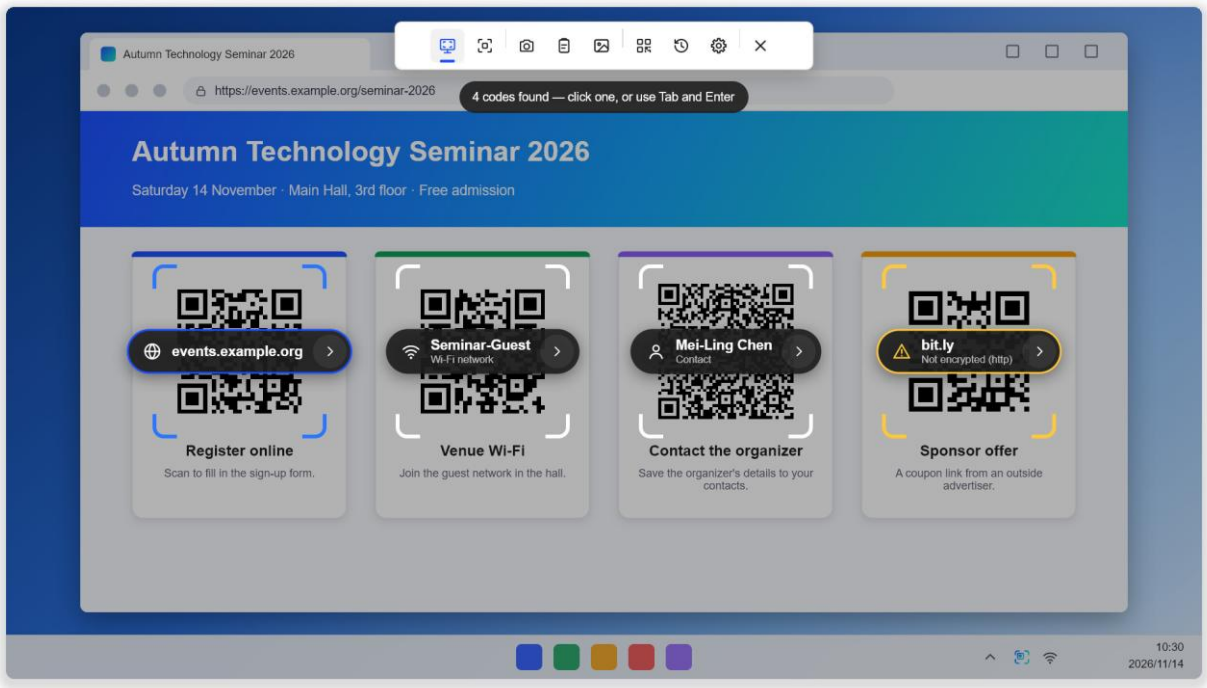


Figure 3-1 Scan whole screen: every code gets a label; the first one is selected

The status chip at the top shows how many codes were found. The colour of the brackets around each code tells you the result of the checks:

Bracket colour	Meaning
White	Nothing suspicious was found.
Accent (blue)	The selected code. **Enter** opens it.

Bracket colour	Meaning
Yellow	Something deserves attention, for example an unencrypted http link or a short link. The reason is shown under the label.
Red	The link looks deceptive, for example a disguised address or a domain that mixes alphabets.

Because the screen is frozen, codes in videos, presentations and games can be read too. With several monitors, all of them are scanned at the same time.

3.2 Select an area

When a code is small, blurry or tilted, or when there are many codes on the screen, draw a box around just the one you need. The selected area is enlarged before it is read, which works better than a whole-screen scan for difficult codes.

1. Press `Ctrl+Alt+A`, or choose **Select area** from the tray menu or the floating toolbar.
2. The screen freezes and the pointer becomes a crosshair. Hold down the left mouse button and drag a box around the code.
3. Release the mouse button. Only the content inside the box is read.

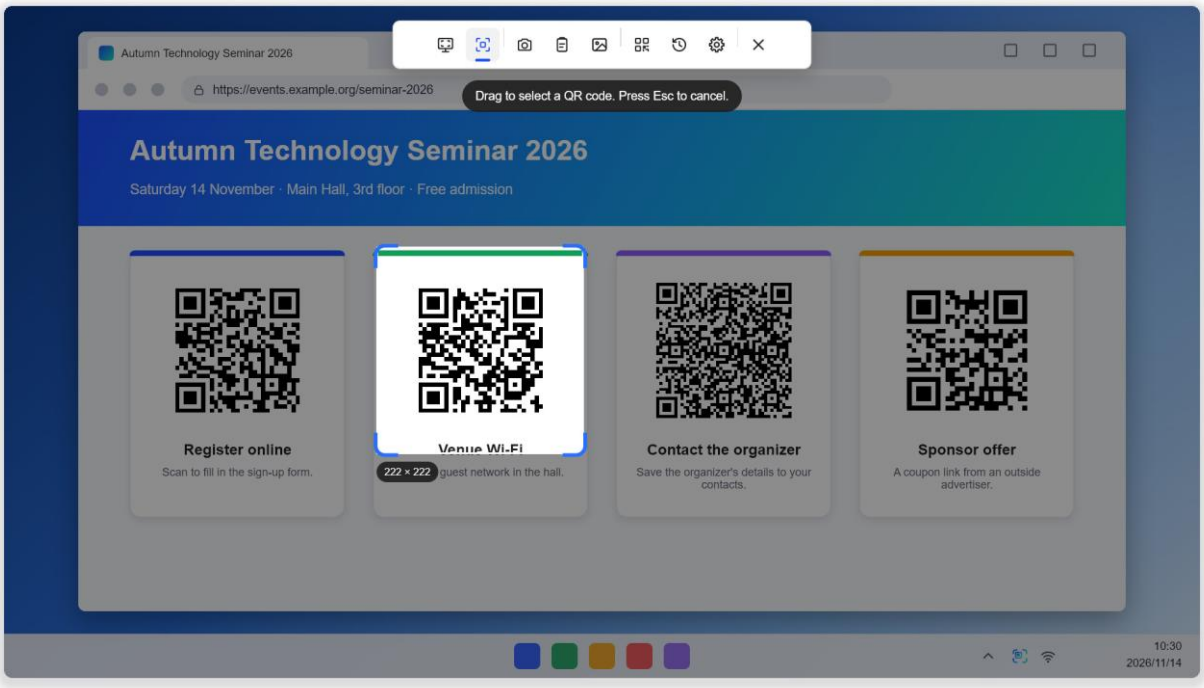


Figure 3-2 Select area: the size of the box is shown while you drag

> **Tip** Make the box a little larger than the code; a margin of empty space around it helps. If the message “No code in that area” appears, draw a slightly bigger box.

3.3 The toolbar on the scan screen

The scan screen has a row of buttons at the top. From left to right: **Scan whole screen**, **Select area**, **Scan with camera**, **Scan image from clipboard**, **Open image…**, **Create QR code…**, **History**, **Settings** and **Close**. You can switch methods without leaving the scan screen, for example from the whole screen to a selected area. Hover over a button to see its description and shortcut.

3.4 Keyboard

The scan screen can be used entirely with the keyboard:

Key	Action
Enter	Open the selected code.
Tab, →, ↓	Select the next code.
Shift+Tab, ←, ↑	Select the previous code.
C	Copy the selected code.
F or F5	Search the whole screen again.
Esc	Cancel and leave the scan screen (right-click works too).

3.5 When no code is found

- Use **Select area** and draw a box around the code only; it is enlarged before it is read.
- If the code moves quickly in a video, pause the video first.
- Move other windows, the mouse pointer or anything else that covers part of the code.
- Check that **Settings › Scanning › Also read barcodes** is on if you want to read barcodes and formats such as Data Matrix.
- If the code is very small on the screen (less than about 40 pixels wide), zoom in on the page or picture first.

CHAPTER 4

4 Other ways to scan

4.1 Webcam

Use the webcam for codes on paper, business cards or another phone's screen.

1. Press **Ctrl+Alt+W**, or choose **Scan with camera**.
2. Hold the code up to the camera at a distance of about 15 to 30 cm.
3. When a code is recognised, brackets appear around it and its result label is placed in a steady list at the bottom of the picture.
4. Click the label, or select it with **Tab** and press **Enter**.

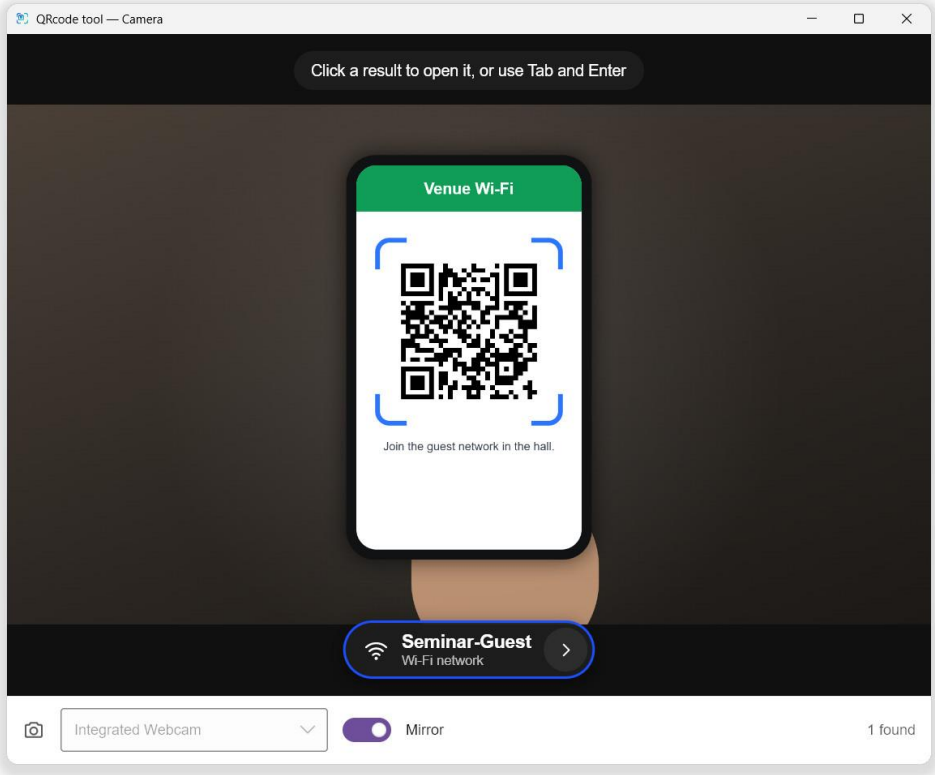


Figure 4-1 Scan with camera: results stay in a steady list at the bottom

- A code has to be seen in several frames in a row before it is listed, which prevents misreads.
- After a code leaves the picture, its result stays listed for a while (8 seconds by default) so you can still click it. Change the time in **Settings › Camera**.

- If more than one camera is connected, switch between them with the list at the bottom of the window.
- The **Mirror** switch only changes how the picture is shown; recognition works either way.
- By default the camera window closes after a code has been opened. You can change this in **Settings › Camera**.

> **Note** If the camera does not start, close other programs that may be using it (video calls, for example) and allow QRcode tool to use the camera in your system's privacy settings.

4.2 Image on the clipboard

1. Take a screenshot of the code with `Win+Shift+S` or another screenshot tool, or copy a picture from a web page.
2. Choose **Scan image from clipboard**.
3. The picture is shown in a preview window, and every code found gets a result label.

If there is no picture on the clipboard, the program asks you to copy a screenshot or picture first.

4.3 Image files

1. Choose **Open image…**.
2. Select a PNG, JPEG, BMP, GIF or WebP file.
3. Click a result label in the preview window. The buttons at the bottom open another picture or scan the clipboard instead.

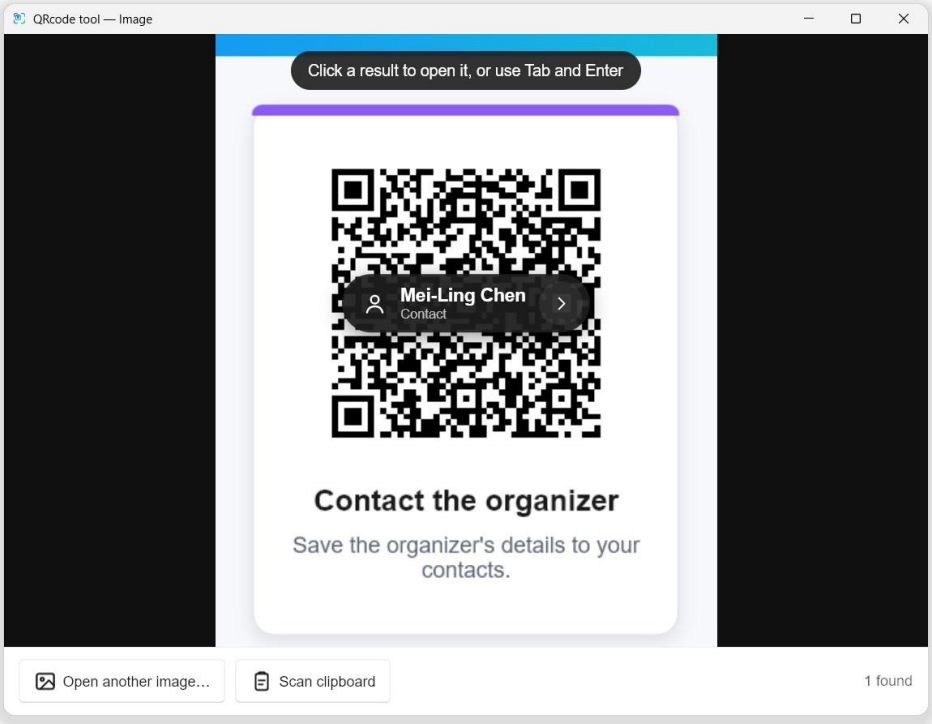
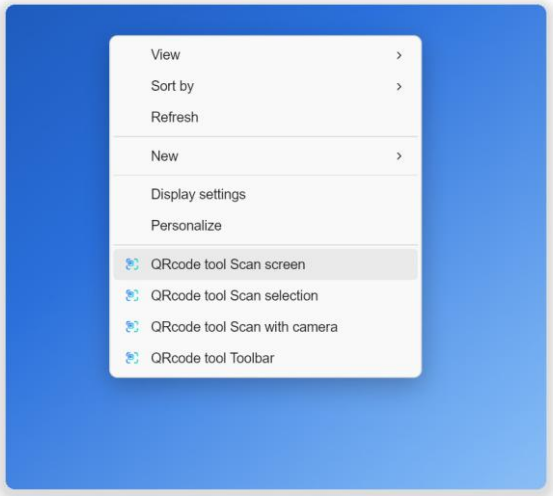


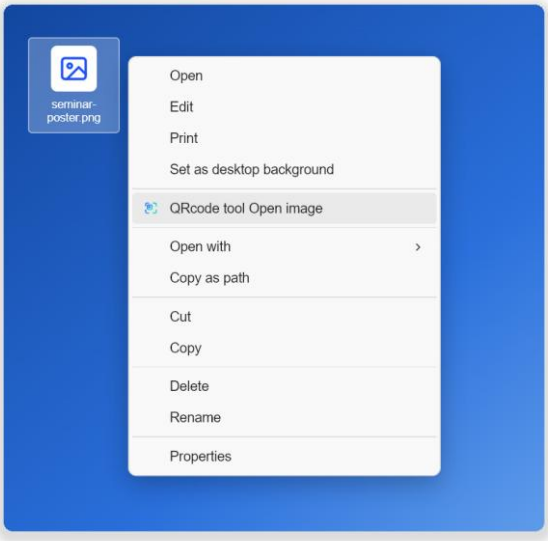
Figure 4-2 The preview window: labels are placed on the codes in the picture

4.4 Windows right-click menu

On Windows, QRcode tool can add its main functions to the File Explorer right-click menu (context menu): right-click the desktop background to scan the screen, or right-click a picture to scan that file, without opening the toolbar or remembering a shortcut.



Right-click on the desktop background



Right-click on one picture

Figure 4-3 QRcode tool entries in the right-click menu (Windows 11, Show more options)

Turning the right-click menu on or off

The right-click menu is **on** by default: the entries appear as soon as QRcode tool has been installed and started once. If you turned it off earlier, turn it back on like this:

1. Open **Settings** from the tray menu or the floating toolbar.
2. Choose **General** on the left.
3. Turn on **Right-click menu**. The change takes effect immediately; there is no need to restart the computer or File Explorer.

Turn the same switch off to remove the entries. They are stored in your own user settings (the HKEY_CURRENT_USER part of the registry), so no administrator rights are needed and other accounts on the computer are not affected.

Opening the menu

- **Windows 11:** right-click, then choose **Show more options** at the bottom; the QRcode tool entries are in the full menu. To open the full menu directly, hold `Shift` while you right-click, or press `Shift+F10`.
- **Windows 10:** the QRcode tool entries appear as soon as you right-click.

Menu entry	Where	Action
QRcode tool Scan screen	Desktop background	Scans the whole screen (like `Ctrl+Alt+Q`).
QRcode tool Scan selection	Desktop background	Freezes the screen so you can select an area (like `Ctrl+Alt+A`).
QRcode tool Scan with camera	Desktop background	Opens the webcam (like `Ctrl+Alt+W`).
QRcode tool Toolbar	Desktop background	Shows the floating toolbar.
QRcode tool Open image	Picture files	Scans the picture in the preview window. PNG, JPEG, BMP, GIF and WebP are supported.

- The four desktop entries are grouped at the bottom of the menu between separators, with the QRcode tool icon.
- **QRcode tool Open image** appears only when exactly **one** picture is selected, not for several files at once.
- The entries use the QRcode tool language. After you change **Settings › General › Language**, the menu is updated too.

- If QRcode tool is not running, choosing an entry starts it and runs the function; if it is running, the running program handles the request.
- With the portable version, the entries point to the program's current location. After moving the portable folder, start the program once so the entries are updated.
- Uninstalling QRcode tool removes the entries. macOS and Linux have no right-click menu entries; use the shortcuts or the command line instead.

> **Tip** If QRcode tool is missing from the menu: check that **Settings › General › Right-click menu** is on, choose **Show more options** on Windows 11, and start QRcode tool once if it was just installed or moved.

4.5 Command line

Every scan function can be started with a command. If the program is already running, the command is passed to it. This is especially useful on Linux with Wayland: assign the commands to custom shortcuts in your desktop's keyboard settings.

Command	Action
`qrcode-tool`	Start the program, or show the floating toolbar if it is already running.
`qrcode-tool scan-screen`	Scan the whole screen.
`qrcode-tool scan-region`	Freeze the screen and select an area.
`qrcode-tool scan-camera`	Scan with the webcam.
`qrcode-tool scan-clipboard`	Scan the picture on the clipboard.
`qrcode-tool scan-file FILE`	Scan one image file in the preview window.
`qrcode-tool toolbar`	Show or hide the floating toolbar.
`qrcode-tool bubble`	Show or hide the floating bubble.
`qrcode-tool generate "TEXT"`	Open the QR code generator with the text filled in.
`qrcode-tool settings`	Open Settings.
`qrcode-tool decode FILE… [--json]`	Print the codes in image files to the terminal without starting the UI.
`qrcode-tool quit`	Quit the running program.

CHAPTER 5

5 Results and details

5.1 Result labels

Every code found gets a dark result label. From left to right it shows:

- **Icon:** the kind of content, for example a globe for a link, a fan for Wi-Fi or a person for a contact. Links with a warning show a warning or danger symbol instead.
- **Main text:** for links, the real site name rather than the full address; for Wi-Fi, the network name; for contacts, the name.
- **Second line:** the kind of content, or the main reason for a warning.
- **› button:** always opens the detail card, whatever the content.

5.2 What Enter or a click does

Content	Action
Link without warnings	Opens in your default browser.
Link with a warning	Shows the detail card first; the link opens only after you confirm.
Everything else	Shows the detail card, where you choose what to do.

5.3 The detail card

The detail card lists every field in the code and offers buttons that match the content. The copy button next to a field copies just that field. Sensitive fields such as passwords are hidden as "••••"; the lock button shows them for a moment. Click outside the card or click **Close** to return to the results.

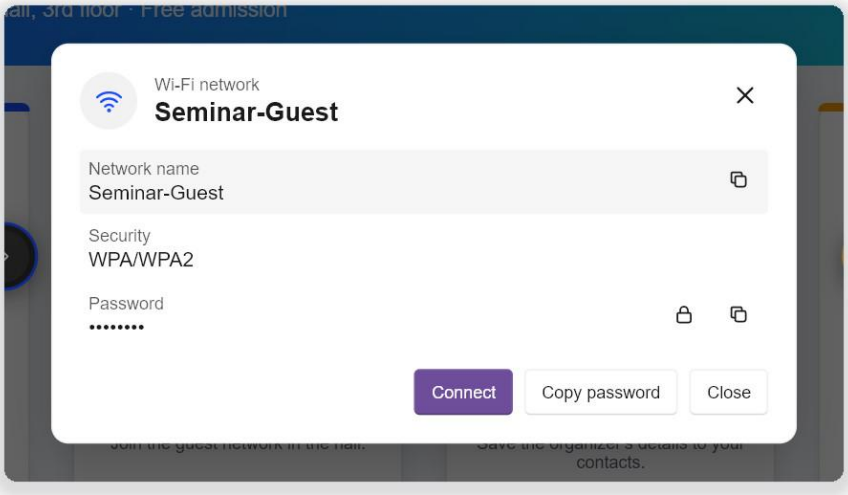


Figure 5-1 Detail card of a Wi-Fi code: Connect joins the network

5.4 Buttons for each kind of content

Kind	Buttons
Link	**Open**, **Copy**. Links without warnings to sites you have not trusted yet also offer **Always allow this site**.
Wi-Fi network	**Connect** (the system creates the network profile), **Copy password**.
Contact (vCard, MeCard)	**Save contact** (saves a .vcf file you can import into your address book), **Copy**.
Email	**Write email** (opens your default mail program), **Copy**.
Phone number	**Call** (handed to the system's calling app), **Copy**.
Text message	**Send message**, **Copy**.
Location	**Open map**, **Copy**.
2-step verification key	Only the service name and account are shown; **Copy** is available. The secret itself is never shown or stored.
Payment address	**Copy**. Always double-check a payment address before sending money.
E-invoice	**Copy invoice number**, **Copy**.
Blocked link	Links other than `http` and `https` (for example `file:` or `javascript:`) can only be copied, never opened.
Text and barcodes	**Copy**. For barcodes the format, for example EAN-13, is shown as well.

5.5 Taiwan e-invoices

A Taiwan e-invoice has two QR codes side by side. The left code holds the invoice number, date, amounts and some of the items; the right code holds the remaining items. When **Scan whole screen** or **Open image…** finds both codes, they are merged into one invoice and the detail card lists the invoice number, date, random code, total, tax, seller and buyer IDs and all items. If only the left code is found, the card reminds you to scan the right code as well.

5.6 Sensitive data

2-step verification keys and Wi-Fi passwords are sensitive. Even with the scan history or **Copy the result automatically** turned on, they are never written to the history, never copied automatically and never written to the program's log files.

CHAPTER 6

6 Link safety

Malicious QR codes often lead to fake websites. QRcode tool analyses every web address on your computer before it shows the result, and marks what it finds directly on the result label and the detail card. Nothing is looked up online, and no address is sent to any service.

6.1 Check the site name before opening

The result label shows the real site name contained in the address. Before you open any link, make sure this is the site you expect. Links with a warning show their detail card first, with a coloured notice at the top that explains what to watch out for.

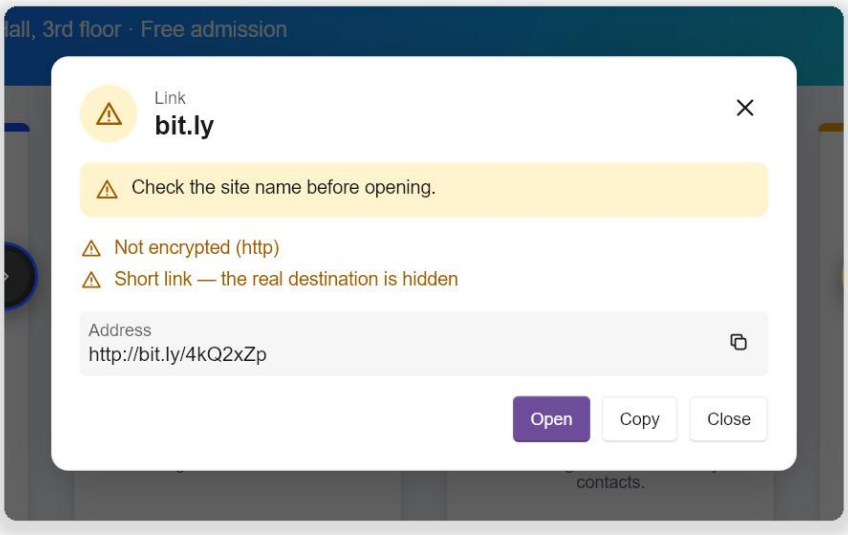


Figure 6-1 A link with warnings: an unencrypted short link shows the reasons and waits for you

6.2 Warning levels

Level	What the program does
Info	For example a very long address. Listed on the detail card only; Enter opens the link directly.
Warning	Yellow brackets and icon. Enter or a click shows the detail card first; you then click **Open**.
Danger	Red brackets and icon. **Open** is no longer the default button, and after clicking it you must confirm with **Open anyway**.

6.3 What is checked

Message shown	Level	Explanation and advice
Not encrypted (http)	Warning	The connection is not encrypted, so data can be read or changed on the way. Do not enter passwords or payment details on such pages.
Disguised address	Danger	A trusted-looking name is placed before an "@", but the link really goes to the site after it, for example `https://bank.example.com@login-check.example.net/`.
International domain name	Warning	The domain contains non-Latin letters. The card also shows the real encoded address (starting with `xn--`) so you can check it.
Look-alike letters	Danger	One part of the domain mixes alphabets, for example a Cyrillic "a" in place of a Latin "a". This is a common trick of fake websites.
Raw IP address	Warning	The address uses numbers instead of a site name, which ordinary websites rarely do.
Unusual port	Warning	The address specifies a non-standard port number.
Short link	Warning	Services such as bit.ly hide the real destination. The link is not expanded online, because that would tell the service what you scanned. Open short links only from sources you trust.
Very long address	Info	Very long addresses can push the real site name out of view.
Many encoded characters	Info	Many "%" escapes can be used to hide what an address contains.
Many subdomains	Info	For example `login.bank.example.com.secure-check.example.net`, which can look like a bank's site at first glance.

6.4 Deceptive links

For links rated **Danger**, the detail card says in red that the link looks deceptive and lists the reasons. Rely on the real site name shown on the card, not on the text printed next to the code.

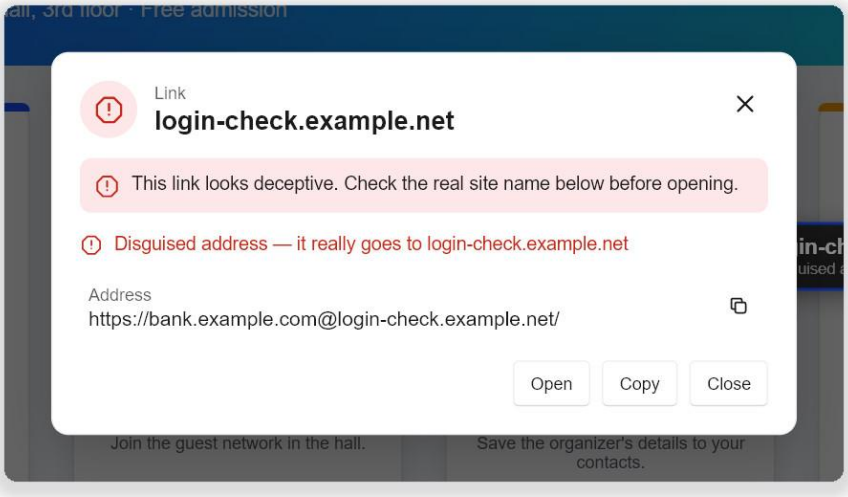


Figure 6-2 A disguised address: it looks like a bank but really goes to login-check.example.net

If you are sure you want to continue, click **Open**. The card asks once more; only **Open anyway** really opens the page.

6.5 Trusted sites and automatic opening

You can add sites you use often, such as your school's or company's domain, to the trusted sites. A link then opens straight after the scan, without waiting for **Enter**, when all of these are true:

- Only one code was found.
- The link has no warnings.
- The site (or one of its subdomains) is on the trusted list.
- **Settings › Scanning › Open trusted sites without asking** is on (the default).

Add a site with **Always allow this site** on the detail card of a link without warnings, or type the domain in **Settings › Scanning**.

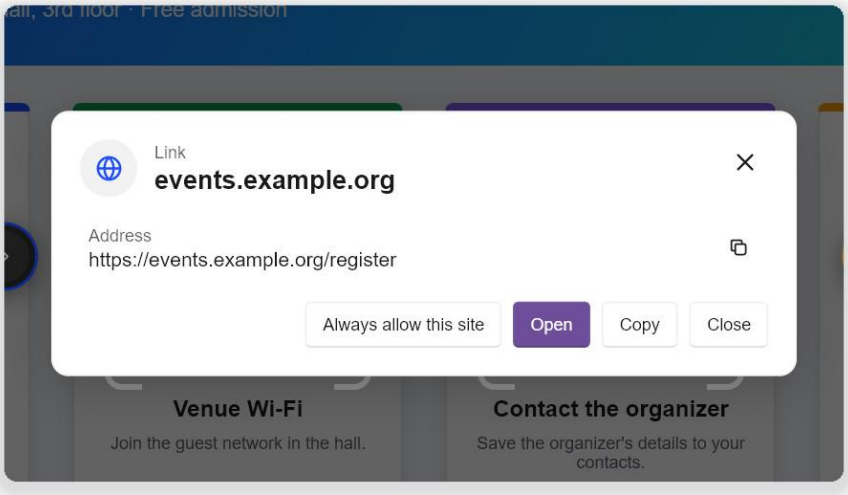


Figure 6-3 A link without warnings: open it, or add the site to the trusted list

CHAPTER 7

7 Floating toolbar and bubble

The floating toolbar stays on top of other windows so every function is one click away. It never appears in scanned screenshots. Show or hide it with **Floating toolbar** in the tray menu, the shortcut **Ctrl+Alt+E** or the command `qrcode-tool toolbar`.

7.1 Toolbar buttons

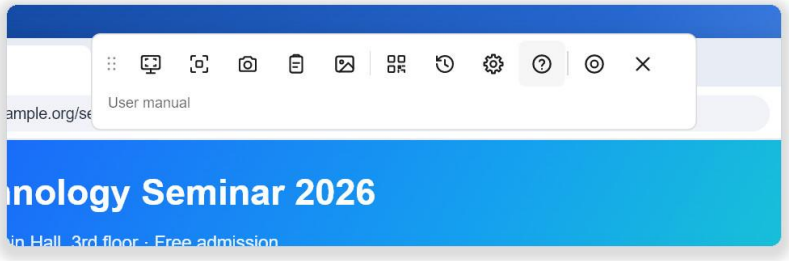


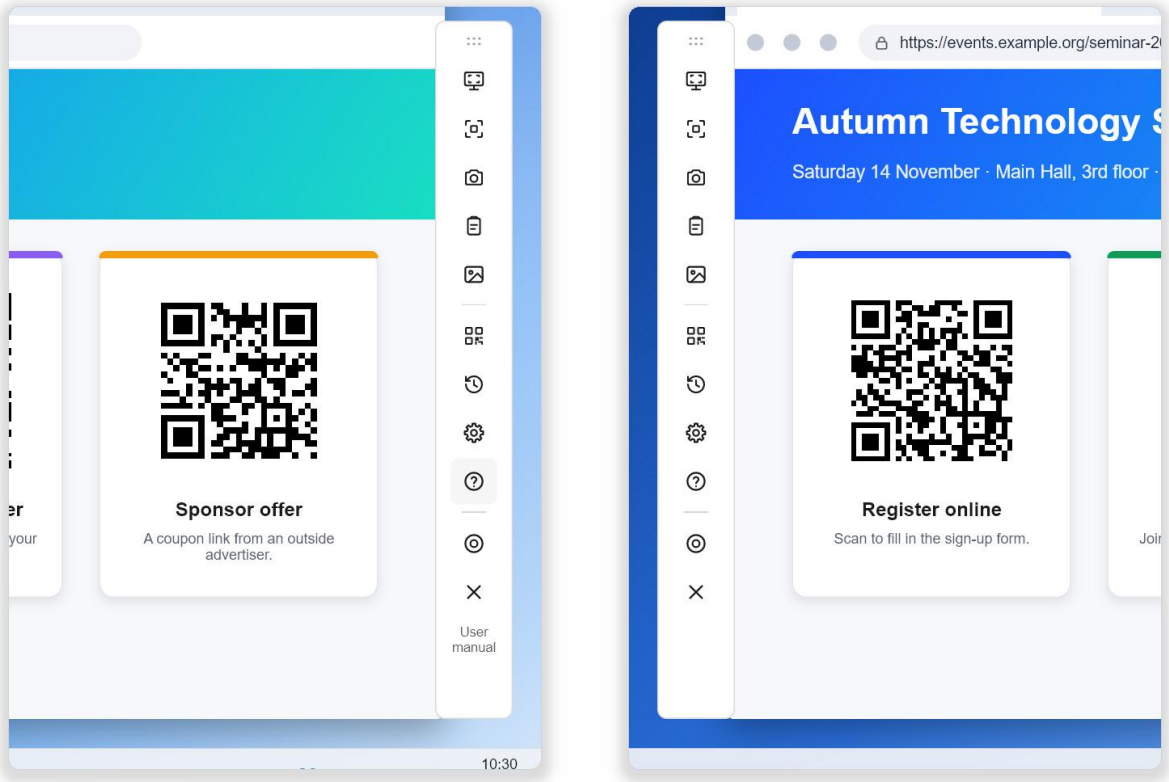
Figure 7-1 Horizontal toolbar: hover over a button to see its name and shortcut underneath

Button	Action
(dotted handle at the start)	Hold and drag to move the toolbar.
Scan whole screen	Same as **Ctrl+Alt+Q**.
Select area	Same as **Ctrl+Alt+A**.
Scan with camera	Same as **Ctrl+Alt+W**. Greyed out when no camera is found.
Scan image from clipboard	Reads the picture on the clipboard.
Open image…	Choose an image file and scan it.
Create QR code…	Opens the QR code generator.
History	Opens **Settings › Privacy & history**.
Settings	Opens Settings.
User manual (“?” button)	Opens the PDF user manual on GitHub in a new browser tab: the Traditional Chinese edition when the UI is in Chinese, the English edition otherwise.
Collapse to bubble	Hides the toolbar and shows the small round bubble instead.

Button	Action
Close toolbar	Hides the toolbar (the bubble does not appear). The program keeps running in the tray.

7.2 Vertical toolbar (right or left)

Besides the default horizontal layout at the top of the screen, the toolbar can be a vertical column at the right or left edge of the screen. The column takes up less width, which suits wide screens and keeps the top of web pages uncovered.



Vertical, on the right (the default vertical position)

Vertical, on the left

Figure 7-2 Vertical toolbar: the name and shortcut of the hovered button appear below the buttons

To change the layout:

1. Open **Settings** and choose **General**.
2. In the **Floating toolbar and bubble** section, find **Toolbar layout**.
3. Choose **Horizontal, at the top**, **Vertical, on the right** or **Vertical, on the left**.

The change takes effect immediately. The toolbar moves to the default place of the new layout:

centred at the top for the horizontal layout, vertically centred at the chosen edge for the vertical one. You can still drag it anywhere afterwards.

7.3 Moving the toolbar

Hold the dotted handle at one end of the toolbar and drag. The program remembers the last position and shows the toolbar there next time. If that position is no longer on any monitor, for example after unplugging an external display, the toolbar returns to its default place.

7.4 The floating bubble

The floating bubble is the collapsed toolbar. It takes up only a small circle and appears at the right edge of the screen by default.

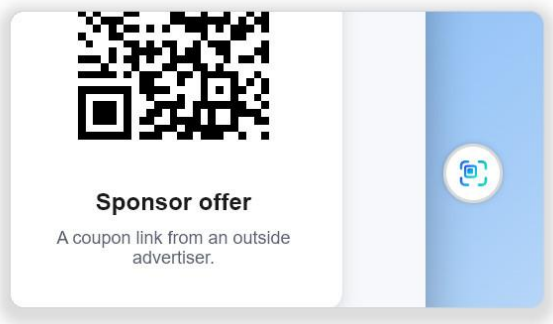


Figure 7-3 The floating bubble

Action	Result
Click	Expands into the full floating toolbar.
Hold for about half a second	Scans the whole screen.
Right-click	Opens a menu: **Scan whole screen**, **Select area**, **Scan with camera**, **Scan image from clipboard**, **Show toolbar**, **Hide bubble**.
Drag	Moves the bubble.

To show the bubble every time the program starts, turn on **Settings › General › Show the bubble when the app starts**. The toolbar and the bubble are never shown together.

7.5 Hiding during full-screen apps

On Windows, the toolbar and bubble hide while you watch a full-screen video, give a presentation or play a game, and come back when you leave full-screen mode. Turn this off in **Settings › General**

› **Hide during full-screen apps**.

CHAPTER 8

8 Creating QR codes

The QR code generator turns a link or a piece of text into a QR code that you can scan with a phone or place in documents and presentations.

1. Choose **Create QR code…** from the tray menu, the floating toolbar or the scan screen.
2. Type or paste the content into **Text or link**. The QR code appears on the right straight away.
3. Choose an **Error correction** level if needed.
4. Click **Copy image** to copy the QR code to the clipboard, or **Save PNG…** or **Save SVG…** to save it as a file.

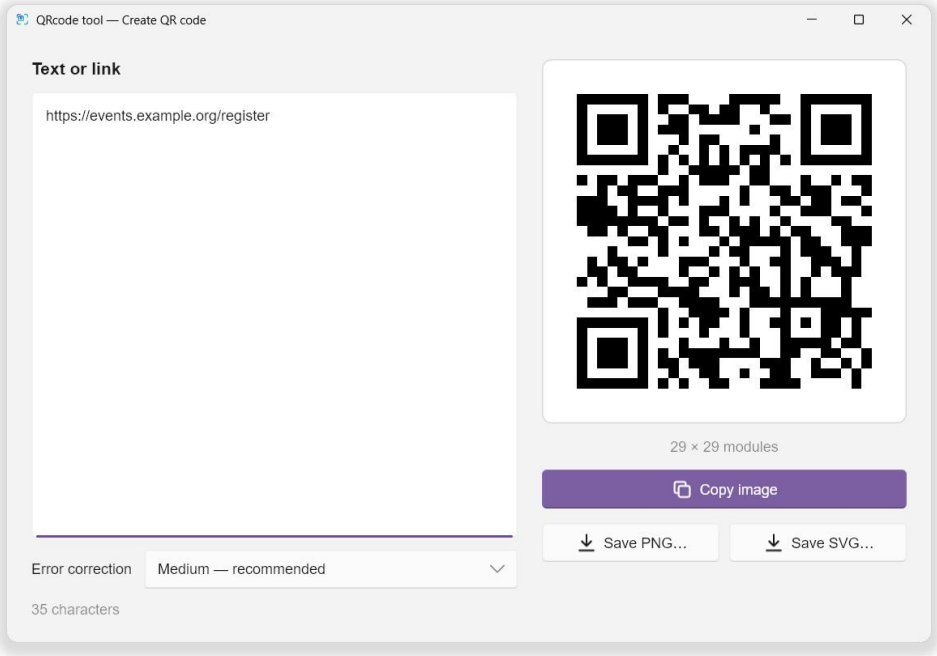


Figure 8-1 The QR code generator

8.1 Error correction

A higher level lets the code be read even when part of it is damaged or covered by a logo, but makes the code denser and larger.

Level	When to use it
Low — smallest code	Lots of content that will only be shown on screen.

Level	When to use it
Medium — recommended	The default for general use.
Quartile	Codes printed on things that may get scuffed.
High — survives damage or a logo	When a logo will be placed in the middle of the code, or maximum robustness is needed.

> **Note** A QR code can only hold a limited amount of content. If “Too much text for one QR code” appears, shorten the content or choose a lower error correction level.

PNG is convenient for documents and slides; **SVG** is a vector format that stays sharp when printed large. Press `Esc` to close the generator.

CHAPTER 9

9 Settings

Choose **Settings** from the tray menu, the floating toolbar or the scan screen. Every change is saved and applied immediately; there is no OK button.

9.1 General

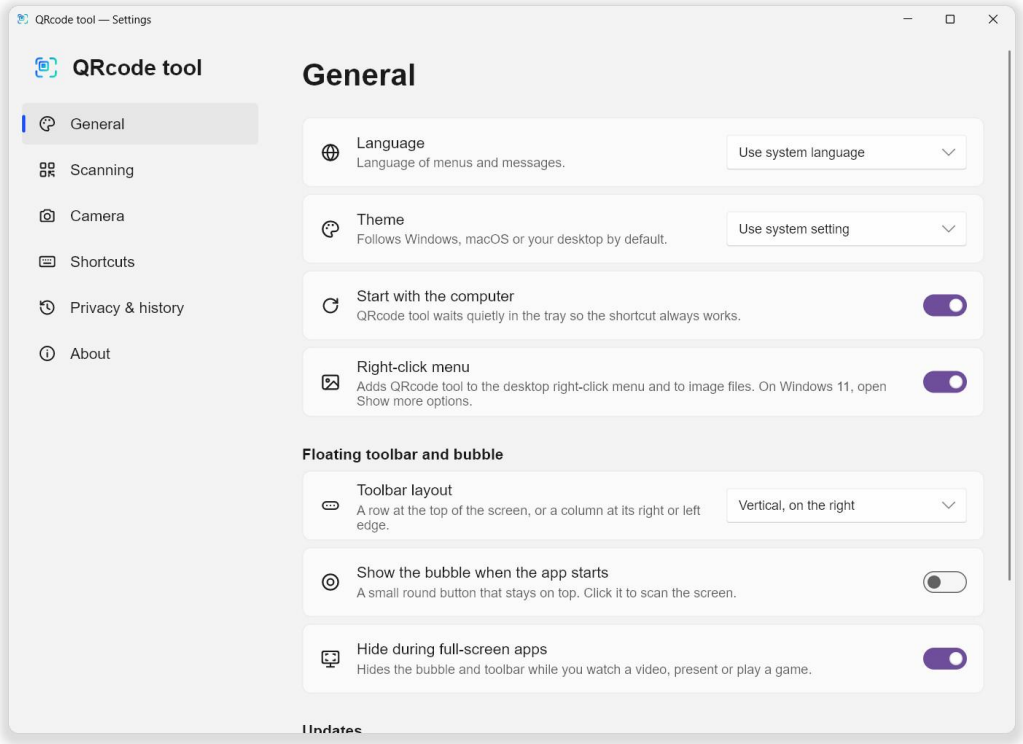


Figure 9-1 Settings › General

Setting	Description
Language	Language of menus and messages. Follows the operating system by default.
Theme	**Use system setting**, **Light** or **Dark**. The system accent colour is applied automatically.
Start with the computer	Starts quietly in the background when you sign in, so the shortcut always works.

Setting	Description
Right-click menu	(Windows only) Adds QRcode tool entries to the desktop and image file right-click menus. On by default; see “Windows right-click menu” in Chapter 4.
Toolbar layout	**Horizontal, at the top**, **Vertical, on the right** or **Vertical, on the left**. See Chapter 7.
Show the bubble when the app starts	Shows the floating bubble on start-up.
Hide during full-screen apps	(Windows only) Hides the toolbar and bubble during full-screen videos, presentations and games.
Check for updates automatically	Asks GitHub once a day whether a new version exists. Nothing is installed without asking you.
Show the welcome screen again	Opens the first-run welcome screen.

9.2 Scanning

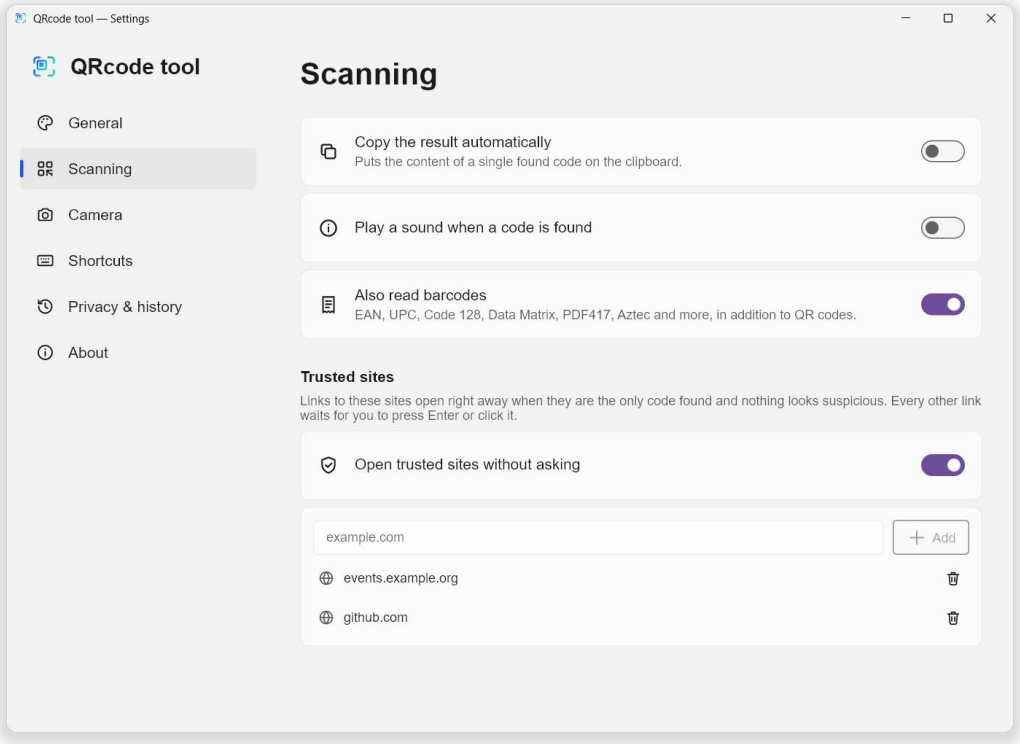


Figure 9-2 Settings › Scanning

Setting	Description
Copy the result automatically	When exactly one code is found, its content is put on the clipboard. Sensitive content is never copied. Off by default.
Play a sound when a code is found	Plays a short sound. Off by default.
Also read barcodes	Reads EAN, UPC, Code 128, Data Matrix, PDF417, Aztec and more in addition to QR codes. On by default.
Open trusted sites without asking	Opens links to trusted sites automatically under the conditions listed in Chapter 6.
Trusted sites	Type a domain (for example example.com) and click **Add**. Subdomains are trusted too. The bin icon removes an entry.

9.3 Camera

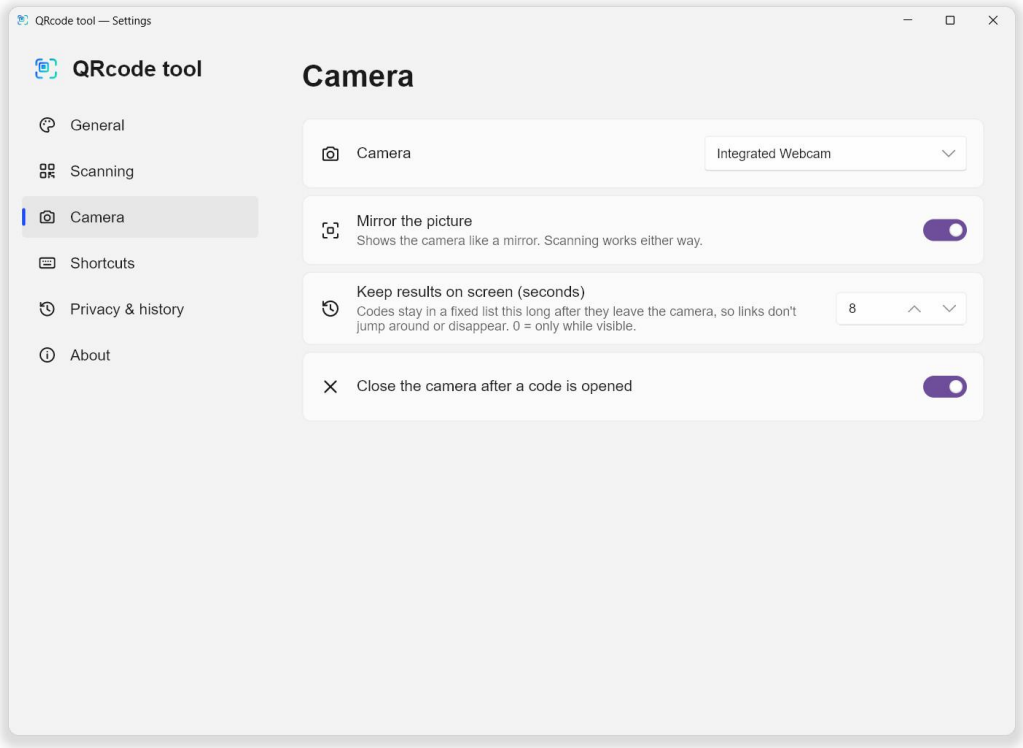


Figure 9-3 Settings › Camera

Setting	Description
Camera	The webcam to use.

Setting	Description
Mirror the picture	Shows the camera like a mirror. Recognition works either way.
Keep results on screen (seconds)	How long (0 to 60 seconds) a result stays listed after its code leaves the picture. With 0, only codes currently in view are listed.
Close the camera after a code is opened	Closes the camera window once a code has been opened or used.

9.4 Shortcuts

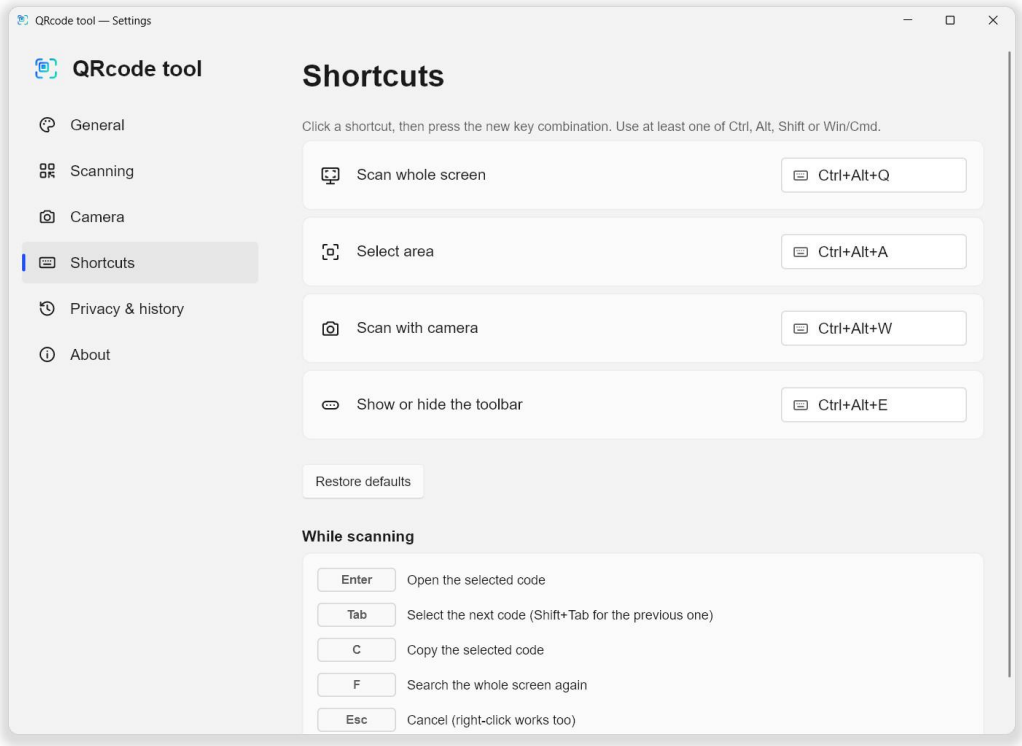


Figure 9-4 Settings › Shortcuts

Action	Default	Description
Scan whole screen	**Ctrl+Alt+Q**	Freezes and scans all monitors.
Select area	**Ctrl+Alt+A**	Freezes the screen so you can drag a box.
Scan with camera	**Ctrl+Alt+W**	Opens the webcam window.
Show or hide the toolbar	**Ctrl+Alt+E**	Toggles the floating toolbar.

To change a shortcut:

1. Click the shortcut you want to change. The button shows **Press keys… (Esc to cancel)**.
2. Press the new key combination. It must include at least one of **Ctrl**, **Alt**, **Shift** or **Win** (on a Mac, **Cmd**).
3. The new shortcut takes effect immediately.

If another app already uses the combination, the row says “Already used by another app — choose another one.” Pick a different combination. **Restore defaults** brings back all default shortcuts. The **While scanning** section at the bottom lists the keys of the scan screen, the same as in Chapter 3.

9.5 Privacy & history

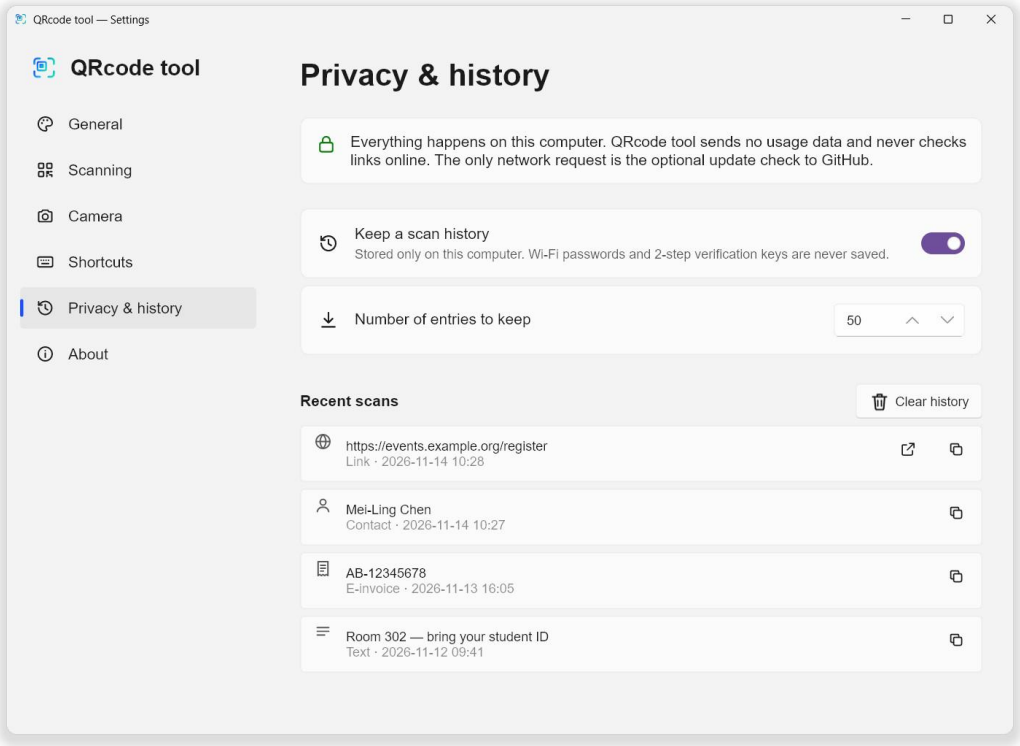


Figure 9-5 Settings › Privacy & history (with the history turned on)

Setting	Description
Keep a scan history	Stored only on this computer. Wi-Fi passwords and 2-step verification keys are never saved. Off by default.
Number of entries to keep	5 to 500 entries. The oldest entries are removed first.
Recent scans	Newest first. Links without warnings can be opened again with **Open**; every entry can be copied with **Copy**.
Clear history	Deletes the whole history.

9.6 About

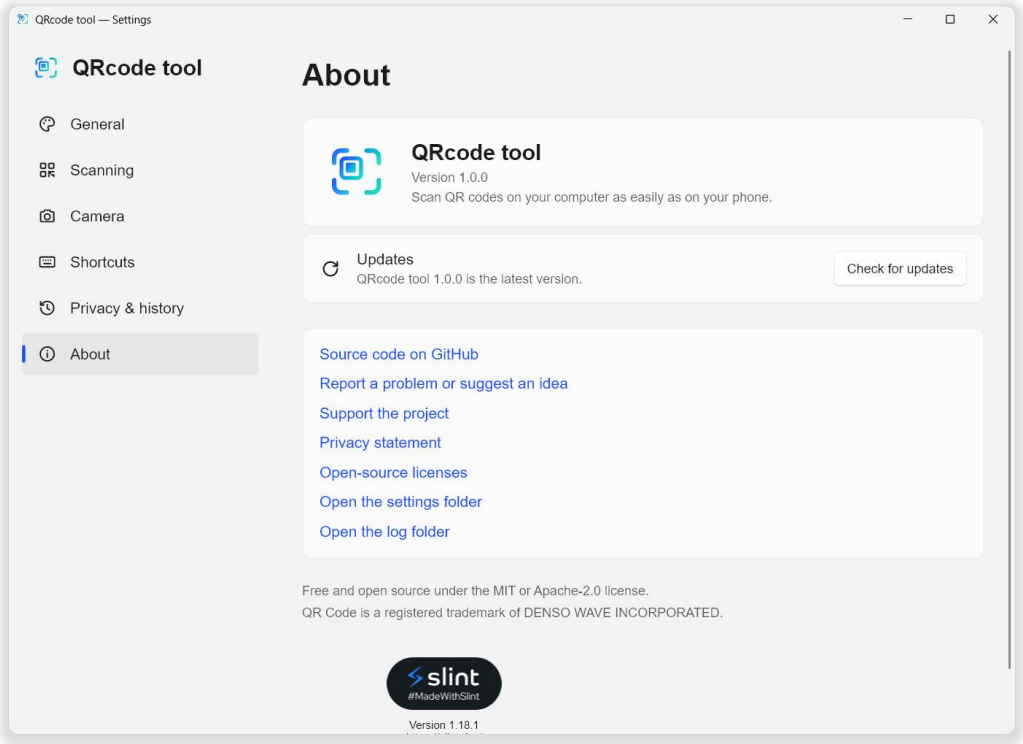


Figure 9-6 Settings › About

- Shows the current version. **Check for updates** checks right away.
- Links to the source code, problem reports, the privacy statement and open-source licenses.
- **Open the settings folder** and **Open the log folder** open those folders directly, for backing up your settings or attaching log files to a problem report.

CHAPTER 10

10 Updating and uninstalling

10.1 Checking for and installing updates

Copies installed with the setup program can update themselves. With **Check for updates automatically** on, the program asks GitHub once a day. You can also click **Check for updates** in the tray menu or in **Settings › About** at any time.

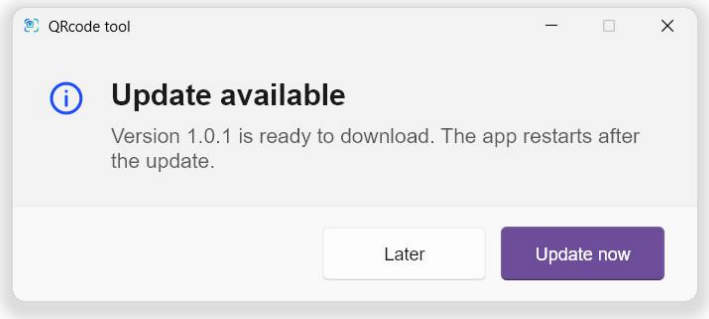


Figure 10-1 The message shown when a new version is available

1. When the **Update available** message appears, click **Update now**.
2. The new version is downloaded in the background, and the program restarts when it is done.
3. Click **Later** if you do not want to update now.

Updates are only installed after you click **Update now**; the program never installs anything on its own.

10.2 Portable version

The portable version (`Portable.zip`) does not update itself; checking for updates shows “Updates are not available”. Download the new version from the GitHub release page and replace the old files. Your settings are kept.

10.3 Uninstalling

1. Open Windows **Settings › Apps › Installed apps**.
2. Find QRcode tool, click **…** and choose **Uninstall**.
3. The start-up entry and the right-click menu entries are removed as well.

To remove your settings and history too, open the settings folder and the log folder from **Settings › About** before uninstalling, and delete them.

10.4 Where settings and logs are stored

System	Location
Windows	Settings: `%APPDATA%\Lrniey666\qrcode-tool\config` History and logs: `%LOCALAPPDATA%\Lrniey666\qrcode-tool\data`
macOS	`~/Library/Application Support/io.github.Lrniey666.qrcode-tool`
Linux	Settings: `~/.config/qrcode-tool` History and logs: `~/.local/share/qrcode-tool`

The settings file `settings.toml` is plain text. Copy it to move your settings to another computer.

CHAPTER 11

11 Troubleshooting

Q Nothing happens when I press the shortcut.

Another app may already use it. Open **Settings › Shortcuts**; if the row says "Already used by another app", choose another combination. Some games and remote-desktop programs capture all keys while they are in front.

Q The scan finds no code.

Use **Select area** and draw a box around the code only, or zoom in on the page or picture first. See "When no code is found" in Chapter 3.

Q Why did the link not open right away?

A link with a warning always shows its details first so you can check the real site. Only links to trusted sites without any warning open automatically, and only when they are the single code found.

Q It says "Short link — the real destination is hidden".

Short-link services hide the real destination. The program does not look it up online, because that would reveal what you scanned. Open short links only from sources you trust.

Q Where is the main window?

There is none on purpose. Use the tray icon, the shortcut, the floating toolbar or the floating bubble.

Q QRcode tool is missing from the right-click menu.

Check that **Settings › General › Right-click menu** is on. On Windows 11 the entries are under **Show more options** (or hold `Shift` while you right-click). **QRcode tool Open image** appears only when one picture is selected. If you just installed QRcode tool or moved the portable version, start it once.

Q The toolbar has disappeared.

Press `Ctrl+Alt+E` or tick **Floating toolbar** in the tray menu. With **Hide during full-screen apps** on, the toolbar is hidden while a full-screen program is in front.

Q The camera does not start.

Close other programs that use the camera and check that your system's privacy settings allow QRcode tool to use it. With several cameras, choose the right one in **Settings › Camera**.

Q Wi-Fi does not connect automatically.

Some networks (for example enterprise authentication) cannot be set up by the program. Click **Copy password** on the detail card and connect from the system's Wi-Fi menu.

Q My antivirus program warns about it.

New unsigned programs that register shortcuts, read the screen and start with the computer are sometimes flagged by behaviour-based detection. QRcode tool uses standard system interfaces and its source code is public. Please report the false positive to your antivirus vendor, or open an issue on GitHub.

Q On macOS the screenshot is black.

Allow QRcode tool under **System Settings › Privacy & Security › Screen Recording** and restart the program. macOS may ask again after system updates.

Q On Linux with Wayland the shortcut does nothing.

Wayland does not allow programs to register global shortcuts. Add a custom shortcut in your desktop's keyboard settings that runs `qrcode-tool scan-screen` or another command.

Q How do I open this manual again?

Click the **?** button (**User manual**) on the floating toolbar; the PDF edition on GitHub opens in a new browser tab. The Word and PDF files can also be downloaded from the GitHub release page.

Q How do I report a problem?

Click **Report a problem or suggest an idea** in **Settings › About** and describe your system, the steps and the messages you saw. You can attach files from the log folder; logs contain events and errors only, never scanned content.

APPENDIX A

A Shortcuts and keys at a glance

Where	Key	Action
Anywhere	Ctrl+Alt+Q	Scan whole screen
Anywhere	Ctrl+Alt+A	Select area
Anywhere	Ctrl+Alt+W	Scan with camera
Anywhere	Ctrl+Alt+E	Show or hide the floating toolbar
Scan screen, preview	Enter	Open the selected code
Scan screen, preview	Tab / Shift+Tab	Select the next / previous code
Scan screen, preview	C	Copy the selected code
Scan screen	F or F5	Search the whole screen again
Scan screen, preview, generator	Esc	Close

The global shortcuts can be changed in **Settings › Shortcuts**. The table shows the defaults.

APPENDIX B

B Supported codes

Group	Formats
Always read	QR Code, Micro QR Code, rMQR Code
With “Also read barcodes”	EAN-13, EAN-8, UPC-A, UPC-E, Code 128, Code 39, Code 93, Codabar, ITF, DataBar, Data Matrix, PDF417, Aztec and more

Recognised content	Example
Web link	`https://example.com/`
Wi-Fi	`WIFI:T:WPA;S:network;P:password;;`
Contact	vCard (`BEGIN:VCARD`), MeCard (`MECARD:`)
Email	`mailto:`, `MATMSG:`
Phone and text message	`tel:`, `sms:`, `SMSTO:`
Location	`geo:25.0330,121.5654`
2-step verification key	`otpauth://`
Payment address	`bitcoin:`, `ethereum:` and others
Taiwan e-invoice	The two QR codes on the invoice

Scan. Check. Then open.

QRcode tool is a free, open-source desktop scanner. It reads QR codes and barcodes from your screen, your webcam, the clipboard and image files, and checks every web address for common tricks before anything is opened.

Everything happens on your computer. The program collects no usage data and never sends what you scan to the internet.

Project page https://github.com/Lrniey666/qrcode-tool

Latest release https://github.com/Lrniey666/qrcode-tool/releases/latest

Report a problem https://github.com/Lrniey666/qrcode-tool/issues

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QRcode tool 1.0.0